

CURRICULUM VITAE
NATALIE S. BYRD
she/her/hers

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EDUCATION

- 2025 – Present **The Pennsylvania State University**, State College, PA
Doctor of Philosophy in Developmental Psychology and Social Data Analytics
Master of Science in Developmental Psychology
Cumulative GPA: **4.00/4.00**
- 2022 – 2025 **St. John Fisher University**, Rochester, NY
Bachelor of Science in Psychology (Honors)
Cumulative GPA: **4.00/4.00** | Summa Cum Laude

RESEARCH SUPPORT

- 2025 Penn State Center for Human Evolution and Diversity Seed Grant
Project: Attachment, loneliness, and self-concept: The role of intersectional identities
Role: Principal Investigator
Amount awarded: \$5,000
- 2024 Summer Research Fellowship
Project: Attachment, loneliness, and self-concept: The mediating role of self-concept during the transition to college
Role: Research Fellow
Amount awarded: \$450

Under Review:

- 2025 National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship
Project: Loneliness transmission and resilience through gene-environment
Role: Principal Investigator

Proposals Submitted, Not Funded:

- 2024 National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship
Project: It is not your fault you are lonely
Role: Principal Investigator

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2025 – Present **Gene Environment Interplay, Penn State University**, State College, PA
Graduate Fellow
Supervised by Jenae Neiderhiser, Ph.D.
Funding source: U01 DA055361; R01 MH130448; R01AG089666

Project summary: The gene-environment interplay across the lifespan, with an emphasis on close parent-child, spouse, sibling or twins, and peer relationships.

2025 – Present **We Are Connected, Penn State University, State College, PA**

Researcher

Supervised by Jennifer Connell, Ph.D.

Funding source: Child Study Center

Project summary: We Are Connected is an evidence-based curriculum that brings groups of undergraduate students together to foster meaningful connections.

Responsibilities: Program weekly check-in, pre-test, and post-test surveys, and develop IRB materials.

2024 – 2025 **Mt. Hope Family Center, University of Rochester, Rochester, NY**

Research Intern

Supervised by Elizabeth D. Handley, Ph.D.

Funding source: NIH 2P50HD096698-06, Sub-Project ID: 8370

Project summary: The longitudinal and multigenerational impact of child abuse, maltreatment, discrimination, and neglect on the health of women and families.

Responsibilities: Code and administer psychological self-report measures (e.g., MOCA, BAI, BDI-II, MACE, ACE, BCES) and biological data collection (e.g., blood pressure, hair, nail, blood draw) from marginalized and low-income adults (ages 24-53) and children (ages 5-15), utilize diverse recruitment strategies (e.g., phone, mail, and in-person), and provide childcare support.

2024 – 2025 **Play and Development Laboratory, St. John Fisher University, Rochester, NY**

Research Assistant

Supervised by Zachary S. Gold, Ph.D.

Funding source: Unit Bricks

Project summary: The developmental implications of children's play with peers and building materials with a focus on engineering play and STEM learning.

Responsibilities: Systematically code observational data of children's STEM playing, run play visits and spatial skills tasks with children ages 4-7, lead statistical analyses for a published article including CFA, help set up the PI's new lab, and design the lab's website.

2023 – 2025 **St. John Fisher University, Rochester, NY**

Research Fellow

Supervised by Jessica R. Robinson, Ph.D.

Funding source: Summer Research Fellowship

Project summary: The role of self-concept as a mediator between attachment style and social and emotional loneliness during young adults' transition to college.

Responsibilities: Conceptualize and propose an independent research project. Manage the entire research process including preparing and submitting IRB and

grant proposals, literature reviews, survey development on Qualtrics, college-aged participant recruitment, analyze study data, and co-author final scholarly products.

- 2023 – 2025 **The Transition to College Study, St. John Fisher University, Rochester, NY**
Research Assistant
Supervised by Jessica R. Robinson, Ph.D. & Melissa M. Goodwin, Ph.D.
Funding source: Faculty Research Development Award (SJFU)
Project summary: The effects of COVID-19 and parental warmth on emotional and behavioral autonomy, overall well-being, and college preparedness.
Responsibilities: Select measures for the assessment battery (e.g., IOS, CES-DC, NRI-BSV), create marketing materials for participant recruitment, lead the data analysis and creation of data visualizations, and co-author final scholarly products.

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles:

1. **Byrd, N.S., McCabe, S.C., Robinson, J.R. (2025).** Constructing connections: A phenomenological explanation of loneliness in first-year undergraduates. *Soaring: A Journal of Undergraduate Research*, 2025(1), Article 3. <https://fisherpub.sjf.edu/soaring/vol2025/iss1/3>; OSF
2. McClure Brenchley, K.J., & **Byrd, N.S. (2025).** Body inclusivity on campus: The creation of a student club. *Eye on Psi Chi*, 30(1). <https://www.psichi.org/page/301EyeFall25Brenchley>
3. **Byrd, N.S. (2024).** Loneliness in the nucleus for psychopathology: Relationships with cognitive, social, and personality disorders. *Soaring: A Journal of Undergraduate Research*, 2024(2), Article 4. <https://fisherpub.sjf.edu/soaring/vol2024/iss2/4>
4. **Byrd, N.S. (2024).** The factors causing high food insecurity in U.S. undergraduate students. *Soaring: A Journal of Undergraduate Research*, 2024(1), Article 2. <https://fisherpub.sjf.edu/soaring/vol2024/iss1/2>; OSF

Under Review:

1. Gold, Z.S., Perlman, J., Howe, N., & **Byrd, N.S. (Under review).** Block play supports children's informal and formal spatial skills. *Cognitive Development*.
2. Robinson, J.R., **Byrd, N.S.**, & Goodwin, M.M. (Under review). The transition to college study. *Emerging Adulthood*.

Student/Professional Resources:

1. **Byrd, N.S. (2025).** Graduate School 101: Less Lonely, More Navigable. <https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/14Dn4rdx1gkr4tBp1H6eMf2IYr09ut5b7>
2. **Byrd, N. S. (2024).** PsycStats ToolKit. <https://sites.google.com/sjfc.edu/psycstats/home?authuser=0>

POSTERS & PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATIONS

1. **Byrd, N.S., & Robinson, J.R.** (2026, April). *Attachment, loneliness, and self-concept: The mediating role of self-concept transitioning to college*. Poster to be presented at the Society for Research on Adolescence (SRA), Toronto, Canada.
2. **Byrd, N.S., & Robinson, J.R.** (2025, August). *Attachment, loneliness, and self-concept: The mediating role of self-concept transitioning to college*. Poster presented at the Hybrid Annual Convention of the American Psychological Association (APA), Denver, CO.
3. **Byrd, N.S., Childs, A., Martin, E., Trimboli, G.** (2025, May). *Adverse childhood experiences in Rochester, NY*. Poster presented at the Fisher Showcase, Rochester, NY.
4. **Gold, Z. S., Perlman, J., Howe, N., & Byrd, N.S.** (2025, May). *Block play supports children's formal and information spatial skills*. Poster presented at the Fisher Showcase, Rochester, NY.
5. **Byrd, N.S.** (2025, April). *Attachment and the impact of narcissism on romantic and parent-child relationships*. Poster presented at the Fisher Lab Symposium, Rochester, NY.
6. **Byrd, N.S., & McCabe S.C.** (2024, December). *Constructing connections: A phenomenological explanation of loneliness in first-year undergraduates*. Poster presented at the Fisher Lab Symposium, Rochester, NY.
7. **Byrd, N.S., & Robinson, J.R.** (2024, December). *The transition to college study*. Poster presented at the Fisher Showcase, Rochester, NY.
8. **Byrd, N.S., & Robinson, J.R.** (2024, October). *The transition to college study*. Poster presented at the Annual New England Psychological Association (NEPA) Conference, Springfield, MA.
9. **Robinson, J.R., & Byrd, N.S.** (2024, October). *The transition to college study*. Poster presented at the Association for Psychological Science (APS) Global Psychological Science Summit.
10. **Byrd, N.S.** (2024, August). *The transition to college study*. Poster presented at the Hybrid Annual Convention of the American Psychological Association (APA), Seattle, WA.
11. **Byrd, N.S., & Robinson, J.R.** (2024, August). *The transition to college study*. Poster presented at the President's Summer Fellows Research Symposium, Rochester, NY.
12. **Byrd, N.S.** (2024, April). *PsycStats ToolKit honors keystone project*. Poster presented at the Fisher Showcase, Rochester, NY.
13. **Byrd, N.S., Magar, P., Morales I., & Smith, R.** (2023, December). *Sleep habits in St. John Fisher students*. Poster presented at the Fisher Research Methods Showcase, Rochester, NY.

14. **Byrd, N.S.,** Grimaudo, J., Hedden, C., & Wilson, R. (2023, May). *People of color and communication in the fight for women's suffrage*. Poster presented at the Fisher Showcase, Rochester, NY.

GRANTS & AWARDS

Graduate:

2025 – Present	Penn State University Graduate Fellowship (\$32,500)
2025	Child Study Center Strumpf Travel Award (\$800)
2025	NSF Grant Incentive Award (\$1,000)
2025	College of Liberal Arts Scholarship (\$2,000)
2025	Científico Latino Alumni Scholarship (\$1,000)

Undergraduate:

2025	Trustees Ranking Scholar Award (<i>For graduating with the highest cumulative GPA</i>)
2025	Provost's Award for Best Paper (<i>"Loneliness is the Nucleus for Psychopathology"</i>)
2025	Award for Scholarly Activity in Psychology (<i>Student most committed to research</i>)
2025	Award for Academic Achievement in Psychology (<i>Highest GPA within the major</i>)
2025	Cardinal Awards: Impact Award (<i>Nominated</i>)
2025	Cardinal Awards: Student Publication of the Year (<i>Nominated</i>)
2025	Cardinal Awards: Club Collaboration of the Year (<i>Won on behalf of The Body Talk</i>)
2024	Científico Latino Graduate Student Mentorship Initiative Scholarship (\$200)
2024	oSTEM Graduate Application Financial Aid Program (\$315)
2024	Dean of Arts and Sciences Travel Grant (\$300)
2024	St. John Fisher University Special Case Club Funding (\$900)
2024	Student Scholar Travel Grant (\$250)
2024	Career Accelerator Grant (\$230, \$135)
2024	Fisher Flight Award (<i>Fully funded trip to Boston, MA to network with alumni</i>)
2024 – 2025	Leadership Development Scholarship (<i>For leadership on & off-campus, \$1,000</i>)
2022 – 2025	Dean's List (<i>Awarded semesterly for achieving a GPA above 3.50</i>)
2022 – 2025	Trustee Merit Scholarship (<i>Highest merit scholarship, awarded \$19,000 annually</i>)
2022 – 2025	Honors Scholarship (<i>Honors program scholarship, awarded \$2,000 annually</i>)

Pre-baccalaureate:

2022	Valedictorian Honors (<i>Awarded by graduating top of 360 student high school class</i>)
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INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Research Tools:

2024 Literature Monitoring Dashboard

Personal Project

- Designed and deployed a fully automated research literature dashboard that fetches new relevant journal articles daily from multiple APIs (e.g., PubMed), using keyword matching and citation tracking of key seed papers. Built a relevance scoring algorithm that weights keyword matches and applies multipliers for priority journals. The dashboard includes read/unread tracking,

real-time search, APA 7 citation formatting, library proxy integration, open-access PDF retrieval, and one-click export to the Zotero API. Developed using JavaScript (Next.js, Node.js), PostgreSQL (Supabase), and Github Actions for scheduled automation, with deployment via Vercel.

2024

PsycStats Toolkit

St. John Fisher University Honors Keystone Project

- Founded a website for students as a toolkit for psychological statistics. Regularly update a library of resources and attend to the help request log.
[View PsycStats ToolKit](#)

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

Teaching:

2024 – 2025

Center for Writing and Tutoring

Peer Tutor for Advanced Statistics (PSYC204), Basic Statistics (PSYC201), Research Methods (PSYC200), & Data Analysis in Psych Science (PSYC1105)

St. John Fisher University, Rochester, NY

- Provide guidance on understanding of course materials and assignments utilizing diverse methods learned from the course and teaching training.
- Accommodate 10+ diverse students' needs and help them excel in courses.

Guest Lectures:

03/2025

Cardinal Experience (CORE4990)

St. John Fisher University, Rochester, NY

Lecture: Adverse childhood experience in Rochester, NY.

04/2024

The Causes and Consequences of Human Diversity (HNRS2599)

St. John Fisher University, Rochester, NY

Lecture: The biological perspective of diversity in sex, gender, and sexuality.

02/2024,
10/2024**Professional Development I (PSYC195)**

St. John Fisher University, Rochester, NY

Lecture: Field experience, research, internships, leadership opportunities, etc.

Invited Talks:

08/2025

Científico Latino Graduate School Mentorship Initiative

Webinar

Lecture: Applying to graduate programs in STEM

03/2025

A Taste of Fisher (School of Arts and Sciences Recruitment Event)

St. John Fisher University, Rochester, NY

Lecture: Research and scholarly involvement at Fisher.

03/2024, **Spend-a-Day (Psychology Department Recruitment Event)**
 03/2025 St. John Fisher University, Rochester, NY
Lecture: Opportunities and coursework in psychology at Fisher.

Mentoring Activities:

2025 – Present **NextGen Psych Scholars**

Mentor

- Provide one-on-one insights into applying to Psychology PhD programs and revisions to application materials to ensure a successful cycle.

2025 – Present **Cientifico Latino Graduate Student Mentorship Initiative**

Mentor

- Provide one-on-one insights into applying to STEM PhD programs and revisions to application materials to ensure a successful cycle.

2024 – 2025 **Research Girl**

Mentor

- Provide one-on-one weekly formal mentorship to help high-school and early undergraduate students secure STEM research assistant positions.

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT & LEADERSHIP

2025 – Present **The Pennsylvania State University, We Are Connected**

Researcher

- Create and monitor weekly check-in surveys for a seminar focused on fostering meaningful connections to promote well-being and retention in marginalized first-year and transfer students.

2025 – Present **The Pennsylvania State University, Psychology Recruitment and Retention**

Committee Member

- Plan events and spearhead initiatives to increase belonging for current students, and ensure equitable recruitment practices for prospective PhD students.

2024 – Present **Academic Memories, Brain Blog**

Scientific Editor

- Peer-review monthly brain science and graduate school posts to ensure accessibility of knowledge.

2024 – 2025 **St. John Fisher University, Honors Student Advisory Board**

Representative

- Plan honors events, implement program changes including a monthly newsletter, and disseminate communications related to the honors program.

2023 – 2025 **St. John Fisher University, The Body Talk**

Co-Founder and President

- Lead a club on campus centered around events to build community for those passionate about well-being, body positivity and stigma, and eating disorder advocacy. Successfully formulate the club's budget, totaling \$12,000. OSF

2023 – 2025 **St. John Fisher University**, Committee of Campus Climate Planning

Student Representative

- One of two undergraduates chosen to represent the student body at faculty DEI committee meetings to conceptualize, implement, and analyze a campus-wide survey assessing diversity, equity & inclusion.

2023 – 2024 **St. John Fisher University**, Committee of Belonging

Co-Chair

- Held workshops for student senator project ideas including implementing a campus wide DEI survey, and increasing awareness of educational outreach programs, such as TRIO/CSTEP.

2023 – 2024 **St. John Fisher University**, Student Government Association

Senator of Commuter Students

- Represented the interests of commuter students through leading projects, disseminating email communications, and volunteering at monthly student events to support coordination and student enjoyment.

WORK EXPERIENCE

06/2024 – **Excellus BlueCross BlueShield**, Rochester, NY (Hybrid)

08/2025 *Research Insights Intern*

- Originated a high-impact research initiative on loneliness, informing a 2025 Health Plan strategic priority; led survey design and analysis that directly shaped member-facing resources and community partnerships.
- Designed and conducted four independent member market research studies on pharmacy experience, communication preferences, mobile app usage, and GenZ utilizing Qualtrics surveys & focus groups in collaboration with UX & CX.
- Developed an interactive Power BI dashboard from scratch to visualize broker satisfaction data, enhancing reporting efficiency and decision-making for stakeholders.
- Created a quarterly newsletter for feedback forum members, translating survey insights into transparent and engaging communications.
- Supported ongoing research on member, employer, broker, and provider satisfaction, ensuring data quality and crafting compelling data visualizations to drive storytelling and strategic decisions.

06/2023 – **Excellus BlueCross BlueShield**, Rochester, NY (Hybrid)

05/2024 *Human Resources Intern*

- As the youngest intern, led a clinical turnover evaluation project, by devising and presenting recommendations leveraging HR data, industry research, and employee engagement surveys.

- Managed the collection, analysis, and benchmarking of performance appraisal calibration feedback data, utilizing data visualization techniques to present key insights and drive process improvement.

MEDIA ACTIVITIES

2025	SJF News, “ #Fisher2025: For Psychology Grad, Next Stop is Doctoral Degree ”
2025	SJF News, “ Countdown to Commencement 2025: Natalie Byrd ”

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2026 – Present	Society for Research on Adolescence, Student Member
2025 – Present	Graduate Women in Science, National and Penn State Chapter Member
2025 – Present	Científico Latino Graduate Student Mentorship Initiative, Alumni Member
2024 – 2025	Científico Latino Graduate Student Mentorship Initiative, Scholar
2024 – Present	Council on Undergraduate Research (Psychology Division), Member
2024 – Present	Psi Chi National Psychology Honor Society, Member
2024 – Present	National Alliance on Mental Illness (National/NY/Rochester), Member
2024 – Present	American Psychological Association (Division 1 - General), Member
2023 – Present	American Psychological Association (Division 7 - Developmental), Member
2023 – 2025	American Psychological Association, Student Affiliate & Campus Ambassador
2023 – 2025	Alpha Mu Gamma International Foreign Language Honor Society, Member

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAININGS

Statistics and Research Methods:

05/2024	CenterStat Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) Workshop (<i>18 hours</i>)
05/2024	Qualtrics Platform Essentials (<i>4 hours</i>)
04/2024	APA Science Training: Eye-Tracking Methods and Research Designs (<i>1.5 hours</i>)

Responsible Conduct of Research:

10/2025	Research Data Management (<i>1 hour</i>)
07/2024	LinkedIn Learning: DEI (<i>7.5 hours</i>)
06/2024	CITI Program Responsible Conduct of Research (<i>5 hours</i>)
02/2024	CITI Program Social-Behavioral-Educational Researchers (<i>1 hour</i>)
02/2024	EHS Laboratory Safety Training Standard Chemical 2024 (<i>1 hour</i>)
01/2024	UR Medical Center HIPAA Privacy and Security (<i>1.5 hours</i>)
01/2024	New York State OCFS Mandated Reporter (<i>2 hours</i>)
10/2023	CITI Program Social & Behavioral Research (<i>4.5 hours</i>)

Teaching:

04/2025	CRLA International Tutor Training Program Certification (<i>10 hours</i>)
04/2024	STP-GSTRA Learning Science to Help Students Succeed Workshop (<i>2 hours</i>)
03/2024	LinkedIn Learning: How to Be a Good Mentee and Mentor (<i>1 hour</i>)
05/2022	New York State Seal of Biliteracy: French

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ad-Hoc Journal Reviews: Emerging Adulthood

Ad-Hoc Grant Reviews: PSU CHED Seed Grant

Ad-Hoc Poster Proposal Reviews: APA Div 7

SPECIAL SKILLS

Technical: Jamovi, SPSS, RStudio, GraphPad Prism, Zotero, Qualtrics, Lyssna, Prolific, Sona Systems, Git/GutHub

Research: Recruitment & scheduling, narrative coding, observational coding, literature reviews, IRB submission, grant writing, measure administration, data visualization, survey design

Statistical: Structural Equation Modeling (SEM), regression, mediation and moderation, correlation, ANOVA, t-test

Language: R (Intermediate), HTML (Beginner), JavaScript (Beginner), SQL (Beginner), French (A2)